

Somerset County

Bickford, Kara

FAIRFIELD

I would like to be a delegate from Somerset County because representation is actually pretty low here for Democrats. I am surrounded by Republican constituents. I voted for Graham Platner because I've been following him for a year and I loved his conviction in his message. I align with his policies and I do not want to see any establishment Democrats in office of any kind. I think I represent the majority of Democrats in my area when I say we are not going to vote for anyone who takes money from AIPAC or any big PACS for that matter. Graham was building something that was different and exciting and defiant and I want to see that continued with whoever the new candidate is.

Blanchard, Jessica B

PALMYRA

I would be honored to serve as a Somerset County delegate to the Nominating Convention because this is a critical moment for Maine Democrats, for our party's credibility, and for the future of this U.S. Senate race. As Vice Chair of the Somerset County Democratic Committee and a candidate for Maine House District 69, I understand how important it is that this process be fair, transparent, and focused on selecting a nominee who can win statewide and connect with voters here in CD 2. Defeating Susan Collins will require unity, discipline, and a candidate who can earn trust quickly across rural Maine. I am committed to helping our nominee do that work. In Somerset County, I will continue organizing volunteers, communicating clearly with local voters, supporting voter outreach, and helping turn frustration and disappointment into action. The grassroots energy that has been built in this race is real, and we cannot afford to lose it. People gave their time, money, and hope because they believe Maine deserves better representation in the U.S. Senate. My goal is to help honor that energy by keeping people engaged, welcomed, and focused on the work ahead: talking to voters, building local capacity, and electing a Democrat who will fight for working families, rural communities, reproductive freedom, health care, and democracy.

Bolduc, Amy C

FAIRFIELD

I am seeking to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I believe our party is strongest when Democrats come together to give a meaningful voice in shaping our future. I am concerned about the divide over recent events and want to express how important it is that we all work together and come to a compromise that every democratic voter can rally for in this short period of time to campaign. This is my first time volunteering for a role such as this, but I feel that this

election cycle is critical to our party and the future of democracy in our country. I am a lifelong Mainer and have been a critical care nurse in Maine Hospitals for over 15-years. Before becoming a nurse, I worked as a reporter, and both careers have reinforced my belief in the importance of truth, accountability, and public service. As a nurse, I have seen firsthand why protecting Mainers' access to quality, affordable healthcare is so important. In my volunteer work at local food banks in Waterville, I have seen the financial struggles many Mainers face and the importance of ensuring every family has the support they need. These experiences motivate me to help nominate a candidate who will fight for working families, safeguard our democracy, and strengthen our communities. To help defeat Senator Susan Collins in November, I want to stress the importance of engaging voters in my community. I will also use my personal and professional networks to

Brill, Terri

FAIRFIELD

I appreciate everything that party leadership has done so far to facilitate as smooth and transparent a process as possible. It is absolutely vital that we choose a candidate who can speak to the needs of working people and bold progressive policies that energized both voters and volunteers. I plan to support Troy Jackson as our nominee and hope those who also support him will select me as a delegate. I have organized my schedule so that I can knock on doors EVERY weekday morning in September and October and any other time I can arrange childcare. I can also doorknock on Tuesday and Wednesday evenings.

LGBTQIA+, Disability, Underrepresented Religion

Bryant, Alexa

HARTLAND

Graham Platner's Senate campaign ended not because of his messaging, but because of the individual delivering it. The people of Maine voted for his progressive policies in an effort to challenge the status quo that Susan Collins represents. I appreciate the party leadership's commitment to upholding democracy in the most logistically-sound and transparent way possible, and I am committed to respecting the will of the people if chosen as a delegate. The people voted for progressive policies on June 9th, and they deserve a candidate who will continue to fight for those policies. Ultimately, whichever candidate is selected as the Democratic nominee for Senate will need a unified party at their back if they are to defeat Susan Collins in November. I am prepared and fully committed to carrying forth the momentum that has been ignited by this Senate race, and flipping this seat blue through volunteer work, rallies, and getting out the vote. In a time of political division in this country, we will be stronger with a unified effort, which means we must put forth a Senate nominee who supports the policies Mainers voted for on June 9th. By respecting the will of the people in the selection of a new Senate candidate, we will avoid a situation that appears driven by excessive party influence and backroom deals, and we will move forward to the November election equipped to defeat Susan Collins.

Choi, Kelly

HARMONY

I want to be a delegate for Troy Jackson because he represents the authentic, working-class voice that Maine desperately needs. Growing up in Aroostook County as a logger, Troy understands the everyday struggles of rural Mainers. He doesn't just talk about working families; he is one of us. I want to support Troy because he prioritizes people over politics. In an era of deep polarization, his straight-talking, no-nonsense approach resonates. He listens to his constituents and advocates fiercely for their needs. As a delegate, I would be honored to champion a leader who remains rooted in his community while fighting for bold, progressive policies at the state level. Troy Jackson is the kind of unapologetic advocate Maine needs, and I am eager to help amplify his vision for a fairer, more prosperous state. I also believe he can Defeat Susan Collins in the general. The current polling points to this fact.

Condoleo, Ellyrie

ANSON

Crowell, David

FAIRFIELD

To the Maine DC. I am looking to serve as a delegate for the nominating committee. I first and foremost wish to help nominate the best candidate to ensure we have the greatest opportunity to succeed in identifying the best person to win in November. We need a senator who can fully represent all residents. A person who is independent and who has the character to navigate the truly difficult times we are living in.

Davis, Sarah B

SOLON

Even though there are differences in priorities in the MDP, I believe we can successfully unite behind a single senate candidate, and I am willing to become part of that process. We have many good options in candidates, and I think it's critical that we give each of them an opportunity to present to the convention the reasons they feel they would provide the best challenge to Susan Collins. I maintain an open mind and will wait to hear from them, and I will participate in a civil dialog with fellow delegates before making any choices. I know it may take several attempts at reaching consensus, and am I am willing to prioritize consensus over personal ideology in order for Maine Dems of all viewpoints to get behind a candidate that will achieve the goals our party stands for. Even though I consider myself a progressive, I know it is important to moderate my positions in order to win. I consider compromise admirable if it enables us to achieve our goal of defeating Collins. So much is riding on this race for our

state and our nation. I have spent many years in public service, and understand how important it is to listen, and then to act. To be honest, I don't have a lot of time and I don't have a lot of money, but this I can do, and I believe I can do it well.

Dow, Absalom

MADISON

I want to serve as a Democratic delegate because I want to help preserve democracy and protect the future of Maine's representation in this country. I am passionate about being selected as a delegate in order to ensure that the voices of ALL Maine citizens are heard and their rights are protected. My goal as delegate is to help unite our party behind a candidate who will fight for working families, protect our environment, and work towards healthcare for all. We have a vital opportunity to win back the US Senate and defeat an oligarchy, and restore our Constitution to what it once stood for. I am ready to do what it takes to build a brighter future, protect freedom, and revitalize hope for future generations.

Durrell, John

PLEASANT RIDGE PLT

I am a life long Democrat, native Mainer who has always worked for what I have and it's ridiculous that the majority of working people in this state and country can't afford healthcare while politicians get it but literally do nothing to help their "constituents". It's overdue and time to start electing younger women and men to lead this country away from the racist, homophobic Republicans littered across this state and country. I am 54 years old and never thought we would still have to fight for women to have autonomy over their health and personal decisions, my right to vote among so many other important things being taken or attempting to take away. George Carlin was right as soon as a woman has a child, the only thing Republicans care about is letting them own as many firearms as possible, not health care, education, nutrition, safe schools, clean environment anything that is actually important to a well rounded child or their parents

Geagan, Rebecca Justine

PITTSFIELD

I'd like to continue my support of the Somerset County Democratic Committee as a delegate to the convention next week. I've been a member of the Pittsfield Democratic Club and the County Dems since 1998. I've also served on the State Party intermittently through the years. My goals center around keeping my family, friends, co-workers and neighbors aware of Party ideas and activities. I'm also a faithful supporter of GOTV. To me, the circumstances that make this Nominating Committee Meeting necessary are unexpected but also an example of what we learn as we go through life and that is 'you never know'! The best laid plans, the most reasonable course of action - all can turn around in a few moments, as they have here. As a retired high school nurse of 18 years I know I can think on

my feet, create and pivot to the next good idea and work very hard. I'm hoping to have the chance to do that by joining the Candidate Nominating Committee. Thank you very much.

Gilman, Hallie Flint

NORTH ANSON

The upcoming Nominating Convention: an unprecedented moment for Maine Democrats to take thoughtful, concerted action. Thank you for the opportunity to apply to serve as a Delegate. For 21+ years in Maine, I have raised kids, grown a legal and executive career, and volunteered for political campaigns at the municipal, state-wide and federal levels. Like most Mainers, I lean independent. Like all progressives, I am profoundly concerned about the current administration's efforts at home and abroad, and about the unwillingness of our Republican-led legislature to do the job the Constitution so clearly requires. We need to flip the US House and Senate, and Maine is poised to lead that effort. To utilize that lead, Maine Dems need to select a Senate nominee who is both electable and qualified for the job. I am grateful to those running; since the candidates I supported in June are not part of this process, if selected as Delegate, I'll be able to vet each potential nominee without bias. The energy and commitment of long-serving party members and new movement-building voters are essential, but thoughtful vetting will also be key: to win in November, our Senate nominee will need support both deep and wide (not to mention a strong defense to Republican attack). Building on Maine's grassroots momentum means building a broad coalition under a big, welcoming tent. This fall, to flip the US House and Senate, I plan to engage in campaign operations & policy development, fundraising and getting out the vote.

Godin, Frederick R

SKOWHEGAN

I was a delegate back when Hillary ran and I want to get involved again.

Harlow, John

SKOWHEGAN

I support Troy Jackson because I believe he is our best chance to win a state wide election. He has strong legislative experience and is in line with the platform the voters got behind in June.

Hatch, Rodney P

EMBDEN

A recent meeting to see the five democratic candidates for the US Senator was sponsored by the Somerset county democrats. I was impressed with the quality of all. I have know Shannan Bellows for many years first as a State Senator up to her present position as Secretary of State As a public

education administrator I met or talked many times with her and other legislators. But I was also very interested in Democratic positions at the local, state and national levels. In the past I have provided financial help to both State and individuals. I have already started to do that this year.

Hooper, Joel Robert

MERCER

I have been an avid supporter of defeating Susan Collins. I was in anti-Collins's commercial on YouTube at a gas station in Windham, Joel from Mercer. I have disagreed with her rubber stamping the Trump agenda, especially voting for the big ugly bill and allowing the acts of piracy on the high seas of blowing up boats with no due process.

Howison, Crystal

PITTSFIELD

I am hoping to serve as a delegate because Maine deserves to have a Senate nominee that understands our rural state and the challenges facing our communities. I am newer to Maine but I chose this state intentionally because it is extraordinarily unique and I believe in the freedom to seek peace, community, and opportunity that is found here. My background is rooted in service: public safety and healthcare. I've seen how issues like affordability of and access to healthcare, quality education, secure housing, public services, and safe infrastructure affect people every day. These aren't abstract concepts, they are real considerations that have tangible outcomes. I plan to continue exploring candidates and their policy proposals to identify strong Maine advocates to carry forward this grassroots energy by listening to people, not just dictating to them. I will be present and evaluate each candidate's vision against the transparency, honesty, integrity, and service-driven values of Maine residents. Thank you for considering me.

Kusiak, Karen

FAIRFIELD

I've resided in Fairfield for over 40 years and have a good understanding of political realities in Somerset County. The best way to defeat Susan Collins is to nominate a candidate who will capture the support of a broad range of Maine voters. In past Senate campaigns I have participated in phone banks and rallies to support our candidates, and I plan to do the same for our 2026 candidate.

Lacasse, Kelly A

SKOWHEGAN

I, Kelly LaCasse, of Skowhegan, Maine, wish to become a delegate for Somerset County as a proud democrat who believes in this process. I think the importance and pressure to meet this moment is shared equally between our party leadership ensuring a fair and legal process to elect a new democratic party US Senate nominee, and the people who need to rise up and fight together for a more equal and fair future for ALL. I am more than grateful to all the people who have fought hard to build an incredible movement for a better future, and to our party leadership for jumping into action during such an unprecedented time. I would be proud to attend and vote for the candidate that rises to the top and upholds the movement's values. 72% have spoken. Let's work together to win this seat in November.

LeBrun, Paul Hanford

MADISON

I am life long Democrat who has voted in every election since Carter . I have participated in democratic caucuses since living in Maine, knocked doors for several candidates, and was a delegate at a state convention. My goal is first to defeat Susan Collin and second to put forward a candidate that reflects my values that put working class people first.

Little, Shawn

PITTSFIELD

I feel that this Senate Election is quite possibly the most important one this nation has ever had. We must get Susan Collins out of office, I want to be a part of this process.

LGBTQIA+

Lyons, Nancy

DETROIT

I feel it's my civic duty to become a delegate to help form a honest and bipartisan coalition to help the next senator.

Underrepresented Religion

Mattimoe, Julie

NEW PORTLAND

McDougal, Ryan

HARTLAND

I'm Ryan McDougal, a Democrat born and raised in Somerset County. I've been an independent grassroots campaigner since Jared Golden's first race, going around and talking to people in my local area on issues and supporting progressive candidates. I am a firm believer in progressive and socialist policies. America needs more politicians like Bernie Sanders and Zoran Mamdani who champion the working class. Troy Jackson was my first choice for governor even before received Sander's endorsement and I would gladly vote to send him to DC to fight Trump and his cronies. I will gladly serve as a delegate to continue doing my part in ensuring our Democracy functions.

Youth

McGuire, Mariah

DETROIT

I am a middle school teacher, union shop steward, and parent— I have major skin in the game now and in the future. I often am asked by other union colleagues about politics, even going so far as to help younger colleagues register to vote and find their polling place. I understand what's at stake if we don't beat Susan Collins in November, and promise to take the responsibility seriously if I am chosen as delegate.

McQuiston, Ellen

ANSON

Serving as a delegate would be an opportunity to identify a candidate with the character, competence, and experience to serve as a US Senator for the people of Maine, a Senator ready to face the challenges arising from the criminal and self-serving actions of Donald Trump. Susan Collins has enabled Donald Trump as he has damaged the environment; engaged in unnecessary war; discriminated against women and minorities, and defied our Constitution. Susan Collins must be unseated to save our democracy. The small town in which I live has a Republican base, but I respect and admire my neighbors. I hope to demonstrate that as I engage in conversations about the limitations of Senator Collins (who is seen as having brought money to Maine and having supported our veterans). Acknowledging what she has done is an opportunity to talk about what else she could have done and what more can be done. The benefits of our country, blessed with resources and talent, should not be limited to those with wealth or entitlement. The Maine Democratic party is fortunate to have excellent candidates that I can support with my time and money. Consider a society that

provides opportunities; encourages aspirations; protects the health, welfare, and happiness of its people and its environment; and welcomes creativity, innovation, and diversity. This is the society I wish for my family, friends, and neighbors--those near at hand and far away. We are all connected.

Munns, Avery

PITTSFIELD

I am a young person (27) who is passionate about political engagement in an authentic and meaningful way. I am not a political insider, just a regular person who loves civic duty and living out my politics in my everyday life. I am a teacher of English as an additional language to immigrant and refugee populations, and I also lead the Queer Alliance club where I teach. I directly support two of the most vulnerable populations under this current administration that Susan Collins enables. I am deeply committed to beating Susan Collins, and I am also committed to protecting, nurturing, and uplifting immigrant, refugee, and queer youth no matter who is in office. As a young person that is outside the traditional political system (but still making a valuable political impact everyday), I believe I am uniquely positioned to offer the perspectives of my peers who are desperate for generational change when Maine (and the country) often prioritizes older generations. Furthermore, as someone who is not within political insider channels, I can represent everyday Mainers who may feel left out by establishment politics that seemingly have not helped our immediate lives and instead appear to line the pockets of millionaires and billionaires. I believe movements are built through relationships, so I will continue to talk about issues with my friends, family, and coworkers. I will also never stop fighting for Maine's future generations, especially those currently under attack by Susan Collins' support of the president.

LGBTQIA+, Youth

O'Donnell, Mary E

CANAAN

I would like to vote for a candidate who will have a progress platform

O'Neil, Christopher

SMITHFIELD

I support Troy Dale Jackson. Since I first met Troy in 1998 (we stood next to each other as we were sworn-in as Maine Legislators) I liked the man. He told me the story of how he rose to leadership in Allagash, and I was an instant admirer. Over the last three decades, I have continued to work with Troy on various policy issues. Troy's constant North Star has always been "how does this policy help the lives of working Maine people?" Troy's experience, humility, judicious temperament, common sense – and most important – his LOYALTY to Maine – set him apart, and position him as just what we need this year to take back the Senate. While I know and admire all the other Democratic candidates, my choice in this unique process will be Troy Dale Jackson.

Peitz, David

FAIRFIELD

Mainers elected Graham Platner because they wanted a senator that unapologetically stands against genocide, and the rich getting richer while the working class suffers. That is why he consistently outperformed Susan Collins in polls. If elected as a delegate, I will vote for Troy Jackson, the strongest candidate against Susan Collins.

Pfeiffer, Peter H

SOLON

I think Troy Jackson has the best chance of beating Susan Collins.

Pipes, James

SKOWHEGAN

I am retired and would like to use the skills I have learned in college, through my work history, US Navy and as a Knight of Columbus to help Democrats return to the majority in US Congress. Studied Business Management @ Appalachian State for four years Spent four years in US Navy during Viet Nam conflict with a honorable discharge Worked with Battery Manufacturing Plants as a factory manager for 37 years A member of the Knights of Columbus for last 30 years.

Plumstead, Jennifer

PITTSFIELD

LGBTQIA+, Disability

Quinn, Matthew J

CORNVILLE

I've lived here in Somerset County for 47 years. Collins was elected when I was a senior in high school. My entire life I have dedicated to public service. As a former firefighter and paramedic, I've built the ability to make rational and pragmatic decisions during high stress times. If elected to choose a delegate, I will take that role seriously and choose who I think can beat Collins in November.

Richard, Elayne W

FAIRFIELD

We are at a crossroads in our democracy and ensuring the path towards justice for all begins at home with the unseating of Susan Collins. I am not new to this game as I have been a social activist for many of my 72 years and know that we are at a do or die moment. Choosing and electing a new senator from Maine will bring balance and integrity to a Senate that is out of step with Maine and our country. As a community activist and organizer for reproductive justice throughout Maine and a community organizer with my local indivisible group, defeating Susan Collins rings true to my passions. Continuing my reproductive and social justice work, meeting people where they are, bringing truth and mutual aid to my community will enhance all efforts to defeat Susan Collins and begin the process of defeating the current administration.

Robbins, Michelle L

SKOWHEGAN

I would like to have progressive input to the nominating convention. I want to continue the grassroots coalitions of reaching out to peoples of all ages to rally them behind the new Democratic nominee. We need to be transparent, fair and inclusive. Mainers cannot get that gut feeling of being betrayed... we can do this. Real grassroots door knocking, calling and messaging the Maine Democratic way can defeat Susan Collins. We want to encourage young people to follow their progressive leads.

Sanchez, Geraldine G

SAINT ALBANS

I would be honored to serve as a delegate for Somerset County at this important moment for Maine and our country. I care deeply about helping our party communicate with honesty and respectfully. As a lawyer with 34 years of experience, I built my career by listening carefully, communicating clearly, and working to solve problems. I also served on a school board in Cumberland County, where, as chair, I spearheaded successful referenda, budgets, and board elections. I later served as President of both the Maine State Bar Association and the Cumberland Bar Association. Those roles brought me across Maine, where I heard from people working to improve access to justice and strengthen small communities. I tried to carry those voices with me and make sure they were heard. I have long considered myself a moderate Democrat, but Graham Platner's message about the need for change and the frustration many feel with career politicians resonated with me. That frustration is especially clear when I look at Susan Collins. Maine deserves a senator whose judgment is independent, objective, and trustworthy—not one exclusively loyal to Trump and national Republican priorities rather than the people she serves. I would be grateful for the opportunity to help as a delegate. I am open-minded, undecided, and committed to reviewing all candidates' platforms fairly, with a focus on making life better for people in Maine and Somerset County.

Schoenthaler-Ervin, Ann

SMITHFIELD

As a recently retired psychologist, I now have the time and energy to devote myself to advancing Democratic values. Importantly, I am more motivated than ever given President Trump's ongoing attacks on our democratic institutions. I strongly support nominating a candidate who is committed to expanding affordable healthcare, protecting reproductive freedom, establishing universal childcare, strengthening public education, especially every child's right to read, ensuring affordable housing, improving elder care, and upholding the rule of law in the face of repeated illegal actions by our current president. My commitment to these issues is longstanding. In 2010, I lobbied with Consumer Union in Maine to support passage of the Affordable Care Act. In 2024, I canvassed door-to-door in Skowhegan on behalf of Kamala Harris's presidential campaign. Living in Somerset County, the poorest county in Maine and one with predominantly conservative voters, I realize that electing a Democratic U.S. Senator will require hard work, persistence, and respectful dialogue. I am ready to join with other committed Democrats to listen to voters, address their concerns, and demonstrate how a Democratic senator will advocate for and act on behalf of working families, older adults, and all the residents of communities throughout Somerset county.

Seamans, Cheryl A

ATHENS

I am a retired teacher, a native Mainer, who has lived in the small town of Athens for over 40 years. For many years I naively voted for Susan Collins, believing that as a moderate on powerful congressional committees she could be a good influence for Maine people. I stopped voting for her about the time she approved Kavanaugh's appointment to SCOTUS. I now want to do my part to see her defeated. I supported Governor Janet in the primary. I had deep reservations on the character of Graham Platner from the start, but also approved of his policies. I have gone door-to-door during the campaigns of Clinton and Obama and would be willing to do so again. I want to be a part of choosing the best candidate to defeat Collins.

Smith, Richard

SKOWHEGAN

I nominate Troy Jackson for U.S. Senator representing the State of Maine.

Soma-Hernandez, Cynthia J

ANSON

I'd like to serve as a delegate to the nominating convention in Bangor on July 25 th, because I believe we must pick the strongest candidate to coalesce behind to defeat Suesan Collins. I am running for the House of Representatives in District 72. It is a historically red district. However the many independent voters outnumber totals for either party. To beat Suesan Collins we need to saturate the public in the facts. Let's get out there and hold Town Halls all over. Let's work to illuminate the public on why Dems need to regain the power.

Strout, Michael

SMITHFIELD

?To the Selection Committee: ?I am submitting my name to serve as a delegate at the upcoming July 25 nominating convention. Honestly, I have never been involved in politics at a level like this before. But now more than ever, I am determined to step up and make a real difference. ?If you select me for this role, I promise to bring that new energy right back home to our neighborhoods—knocking on doors, making phone calls, and helping our grassroots team fire up local voters. Real change starts in our living rooms, not in Washington. ?My priorities are focused on the issues that affect everyday people: ?Universal healthcare: Nobody should go broke or skip doctor visits just because they get sick. ?Closing the wealth gap: We need an economy that works for working families, not just giant corporations and the ultra-rich. ?Protecting our environment and tackling climate change: We must protect Maine's air, water, and forests, while quickly moving toward clean energy to protect our future. ?Fighting corruption: We must stand up to the incredible incompetence and corruption we are seeing from the Trump administration. ?Right now, I have not made up my mind on a candidate. I want to go to Bangor with an open mind, listen closely to everyone running, and figure out who has the best plan to move us forward. ?Most of all, we need to defeat Susan Collins. I say this as someone who voted for her every single time she ran. But I have

Sylvain, Eric

NORRIDGEWOCK

I would very much like to serve as a delegate to help ensure the message that Platner has been voicing all these months is continued. His beliefs were clear and he spoke for the vast majority of Democrats in Maine. I will vote for the candidate who promises to follow Platner's message the closest but will support any candidate who is nominated in the effort to defeat Collins. Thank you for this opportunity.

Thiele, John L.

BINGHAM

I will attend the Nominating Convention in person on July 25th.

Trogdon, Nancy

SAINT ALBANS

I've been politically engaged for many years & am very aware of the issues facing Maine & our country, incl. the importance of defeating Susan Collins/flipping the Senate. Picking the best candidate is key to our success. Helping to unify the party, keeping both members & Independents who volunteered/voted in the primary enthusiastic enough to canvas, place signs, make phone calls, manage/attend events, & getting out the vote in Nov. will be crucial. I assisted my husband w/ his 2 local magazines, doing InDesign, being a copywriter, as well as writing/editing articles for 16 years until he retired. I am a retired RN who worked in women's health my entire career, developed & presented educational in-services, often with PowerPoint, for co-workers for many years. I have the determination & time to invest to make success a reality.

VAN TUINEN, WILLIAM

MADISON

I AM WILLIAM VAN TUINEN OF MADISON, AGE 75. I AM ADVOCATING TO BE A DELEGATE FOR THE NOMINATING CAUCUS. I CONSIDER MYSELF A LIFE-LONG DEMOCRAT. MY FIRST MEMORY OF AWARENESS AS A DEMOCRAT WAS 1964. MY FATHER, WHO HAD NOT ALWAYS BEEN A DEMOCRAT, TOOK ON THE TASK OF A DEBATE, ADVOCATING FOR LBJ VERSUS BARRY GOLDWATER. MY ALIGNMENT WITH THE DEMOCRATIC PARTY WAS CEMENTED IN 2004. I WAS SURPRISED TO SEE A MUNICIPAL OFFICIAL AT THE LOCAL CAUCUS. HE CERTAINLY AT THE LOCAL LEVEL WAS NOT A BIG SPENDER, BUT HE SAID HE ALWAYS THOUGHT THAT THE DEMOCRATS WERE MORE COMMITTED TO LIFTING THE LITTLE GUY UP THAN REPUBLICANS. THERE IS NO DOUBT THAT IS TRUE. I HAVE NEVER RUN FOR ELECTIVE OFFICE. I HAVE BEEN A DELEGATE TO 3 STATE CONVENTIONS. I HAVE NEVER BEEN A DOOR TO DOOR CAMPAIGNER. WHAT I HAVE DONE, AND WHAT I INTEND TO DO, IS BE A THOUGHTFUL ADVOCATE FOR THE CANDIDATE I SUPPORT TO MY FRIENDS AND PEOPLE I MEET. WITH THE SITUATION WE NOW FIND OURSELVES IN, I THINK DEMOCRATS HAVE A TREMENDOUS RESPONSIBILITY. I THINK I CAN CONTRIBUTE TO THAT PROCESS IN A POSITIVE WAY WITH CONSIDERATION OF POLICY VIEWS SIMILAR TO THE CANDIDATE THAT OVERWHELMINGLY WON THE PRIMARY, THE ABILITY TO ARTICULATE THOSE VIEWS, AND THE ABILITY TO CAMPAIGN EFFECTIVELY. AT THIS POINT I DO NOT KNOW WHO THAT CANDIDATE IS. BUT, I AM COMMITTED TO APPROACHING THE CONVENTION WITH AN OPEN MIND AND MAKING A CHOICE.

Van Tuinen, Lynda E

MADISON

I would like to participate in the democratic convention as a delegate. I am 75 years old, a lifelong resident of Maine; and a lifelong democrat for as long as I have been aware of politics. I strongly believe in democracy and the experience of our “experiment” that is America. I want to do what I can to protect our country. I believe in equality, education, right to health care. I am not enamored by our current national and state democratic committies. I admit to being swept up by Graham Platner- not necessarily him- but the direction our country needs to go. .We need to respond to the energy his campaign created. People are anxious to participate but want leadership that can help us channel that interest into a positive direction. I want to listen to the candidates that have expressed interest in running for senate. We need someone with the strength to create a cohesive campaign in a very short time. We need to try to stand together as democrats to save our country. Sidebar: I wish Bernie was 45 years old.

Verderese, Nancy

CORNVILLE

My name is Nancy Verderese, I live in Cornville. Such great heart and momentum across the Maine political spectrum was invested in Graham Platner when the movement hit a wall at 90 mph. I was part of that crash. Now I feel the urgency to put the pieces together and quickly forge ahead. In my marrow I believe we need a candidate who stands on the platform of critical issues so eloquently voiced by Platner. Those are the uniting concerns we voted on in record numbers and what we want to see acted upon in Washington! My husband and I moved to Maine 6 years ago. I was raised in Colorado/Montana, then segued onto rural western NY state. Upon our move here I intentionally nurtured connections in the community. I substitute teach in Skowhegan MS where I feel the need is greatest. I am involved in a Women’s Club, an art gallery, etc. I’ve put sweat equity into planting native pollinators across our property. My husband, who sits on the board of a local land trust, and I wanted to make a difference in our new community. In turn we have been embraced by the lovely folk of Maine. My diverse history fuels my vision: background in agriculture, single parent for decades, health insurance blues, multiple jobs. Eventually I obtained a degree in education, teaching high-needs students. I’d be honored to be a delegate, picking the best candidate to take Collins out and put sanity into the Senate. Thank you

Immigrant/New Mainer

Waite, Doreen A.

PITTSFIELD

We are living in challenging times. Susan Collins needs to be defeated this November. She has been “concerned” for a long time and is not listening to so many Mainers! I would like to become a part of the solution, and, as a delegate, help to choose the Democratic nominee who will represent us in

November's election. We need someone who knows Mainers, is willing to meet with us regularly, and represents the average worker! Many, many are struggling economically right now. We need representatives who understand this.

Walls, Tracey

EMBDEN

I wish to be a delegate to participate in electing a candidate that will represent the people of Maine with fierce integrity and a strong sense of purpose. Who will fight to uphold the Constitution and to protect our democracy. A candidate who will not only defeat Susan Collins, but work tirelessly to serve all Mainers.

Disability

Warner, Alex

MADISON

My name is Alex Warner. I'm 49 years old Gen X woman and a homeowner in Madison, ME. I'm a lifelong Democrat. I ran a field office for Obama in Iowa in 2012. I graduated from Emerge, a program to support Democratic women running for office, in 2021. I have a Ph.D. in American history. Before I became disabled by Long Covid, I worked as a college professor. I've also been in front line social service work for women, including sexual assault and domestic violence advocacy. I'm a trans-inclusive feminist, queer Jew who is actively pro-Palestine and anti-genocide. I believe in climate change & harm reduction. I believe all humans deserve housing, food, health care, and dignity. I know that we have enough resources to ensure these things for all Americans—and all people across the globe. I've lived in rural Maine for almost 9 years and I have a strong grasp on the challenges facing our state—and our country. We must: -resist facism -abolish ICE -protect LGBTQIA+ rights -ensure women's bodily autonomy -fight racism and xenophobia -end colonialist wars -build communities of care -demand accountability from our public servants -defend our fragile democracy To these ends: it is imperative that we vote out Susan Collins in November! I would be honored to serve as Convention Delegate from Somerset County—and, if chosen, I will listen closely and swear to represent the will of the people in Bangor.

Warren, Melissa

FAIRFIELD

Healthcare as a right - Medicare for All, no cuts to Medicare or Medicaid, lower drug prices, funding for rural hospitals, codifying reproductive rights into federal law. Housing affordability - ban corporate and hedge fund purchases of homes, restore federal investment in housing construction. An economy that works for regular people, not billionaires - a billionaire minimum tax, campaign finance reform including but not limited to bans on donations from foreign-backed PAC groups like AIPAC, congressional term limits, SCOTUS reform, and breaking the grip corporate money has on our

elections and our economy. Strengthening workers and unions - strengthened labor rights and collective bargaining, support for small businesses over consolidated corporate power and enforce existing antitrust laws. End forever wars, oppose complicity in atrocities - End open-ended U.S. military engagement abroad, stop treating endless war as a bipartisan default, oppose U.S. weapons and funding used to enable mass civilian death — including in Gaza — and redirect military spending toward veterans' care and domestic priorities instead of foreign intervention. Human rights for all - including full sovereignty for the Wabanaki Nations, dignified immigration reform and put an end to mass-deportation enforcement Energy and climate accountability - reining in fossil fuel corporate influence.

Wheaton, JoAnna

SMITHFIELD

I am looking to become a delegate to make sure Maine has a senator that will stand up to the Trump administration and get the murderous ICE off our streets and into the courts to be held accountable for their crimes.